

URED

Chapter – 2

1. Various Classifications and procedure of Wahi.

Classification of Wahi:

1. Direct (Without Intermediary):

a. True Dream b. Divine Speech

2. Indirect (By way of angel):

a. Like the reverberating sound of a giant bell b. Like human Speech

Allah's word may be revealed to the prophets in two ways: directly, in the form of true dreams or in the form of direct conversations; and indirectly, by way of the angel of revelation, Jibreel. These ways were identified by Allah in the Qur'an as follows:

"Allah does not speak to a person except by inspiration (wahy), or from behind a veil or by sending a messenger who then reveals (yoohee) by His permission whatever He wishes. Verily, He is most High and Wise."

1. Direct Revelation:

Some portion of revelation included Allah revealing Wahi to prophets without any intermediary by vision/dream or words spoken by Allah from behind a veil.

(a) **True Dreams:** Divine commands were communicated to the prophets in their sleep in the form of dreams that gave them accurate glimpses of future events. A'ishah (RA) said, "Revelation to the Prophet (SAW) first began as righteous visions in his sleep. Whenever he saw a vision, it would occur as surely as the break of the day." This form of revelation was a very gentle means of preparing the Prophet (SAW) for the tremendous burden of revelation in the waking state. Sometimes visions directed the prophets to perform certain acts, as in the case of Prophet Ibraaheem (AS). The conversation of Ibraheem (AS) with his son Ismaa'eel is recorded in the Quran as follows:

Ibraheem: “O my dear son, verily, I saw in dream that I am to sacrifice you. What is your opinion?”

Isma’eel: “O dear father, do as you are commanded. You will find me, Allah willing, among those who are patient.”

Both Prophet Ibraaheem and his son knew that the vision was a divine command which they had to fulfill.

The only soorah of the Qur’aan reported to have been revealed in a vision was Soorah al-Kawthar as reported by Anas ibn Malik (RA).

“Verily, I have given you Kawthar (the fountain in paradise). So pray to your Lord and sacrifice. Verily, it is your enemy who will be cut off.”

True dreams of common people are not the same as the true dreams of the prophets. Dreams of ordinary people might come true but it is a mixture of recollections, fantasies, evil dreams, with occasional true dreams. Every dream of the prophets was a true dream; hence, their dreams are a reliable source of guidance.

(b) Divine Speech: The second method of direct communication by Allah with His prophets took the form of direct speech, in which the actual words of Allah were spoken to the prophets (not in sleep). But a veil of light separated them from Allah and prevented them from seeing Him. This form of communication only occurred with two prophets:

The first was Prophet Musa (AS) who was known as Kaleemullah (the one whom Allah spoke to) for having his main form of communication with Allah like this. Allah stated the following in the Qur’an:

“And when Musa came to Our appointed place and his Lord spoke to him...”

The second was Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ). This happened only once at the time of the Prophet’s ascension up into the heavens (Miraaj).

2. Indirect Revelation:

The vast majority of Allah's revelation was conveyed to the prophets by way of the angel of revelation, Jibreel. The final book of revelation, the Qur'an, was revealed in this way for the most part in two ways:

(a) Like the reverberating sound of a giant bell: the angel remained in a spiritual state and the Prophet (ﷺ) was required to raise spiritually to a suitable state in order to receive the revelation. This method was extremely taxing on the Prophet (ﷺ). During it the voice of the angel resembled the loud ringing of a giant bell. Al-Haarith ibn Hishaam once asked the Prophet (ﷺ) to describe how the revelation came to him. The Prophet (ﷺ) replied,

"Sometimes it comes to me like the ringing of a bell—this is the most severe form for me—then the ringing ceases and I have understood what (the angel) said."

Aa'ishah described the intensity of this form as follows: "I have seen him when revelation (wahi) descended upon him on an extremely cold day, yet when it stopped his forehead would be dripping with sweat."

Like human Speech: The second method was much easier. The angel would appear to the Prophet (ﷺ) in human form and pass on the revelation in the medium of human speech. The Prophet (ﷺ) described this form to al-Haarith ibn Hishaam as follows:

"Occasionally the angel appears before me in the form of a man and speaks to me, and I grasp all that he says."

2. Stages of revelation of holy Quran. Gradual revelation of the holy Quran and the wisdom behind it.

The holy Quran was revealed in three distinct stages, to the vast majority of scholars:

1. The First stage: The Quran was written on the Lauh al Mahfoodh (The preserved Tablet) which is with Allah. But how and when it was written is known only to Allah. He says in this regard:

“Nay! This is indeed a glorious Quran (Inscribed) in the Lauh al Mahfoodh.”

The wisdom behind this stage of revelation of Quran is to show the believers its authenticity that it was written down even before its revelation in a place which guarantees safety and where everything – small or big will happen from the creation of earth and heaven until the end of the time is recorded. This is also a manifestation of the infinite knowledge of Allah.

2. The Second stage: From Lauh al Mahfoodh, Allah revealed The Quran to the heaven closer to earth, in a place called “The House of Honor” (Baitul Izzah). This revelation occurred in Ramadan on the Night of decree. The Quran states:

“The month of Ramadan is the month in which the Quran was revealed.....”

“We revealed it on a blessed night.....”

In explanation of the verses Ibn Abbas says: The whole Quran was sent down to the lower heaven on the night of decree. The place the Quran was revealed to was Baitul Izzah.

3. The Third stage: The angel Jibreel brought it to Prophet Mohammad (ﷺ) in piecemeal fashion catering the needs of human beings. Allah says:

“And indeed, the Qur'an is the revelation of the Lord of the worlds. The Trustworthy Spirit has brought it down upon your heart, [O Muhammad] - that you may be of the warners - In a clear Arabic language.” (Ash Shuara, 192-94)

Ibn Abbas says: “.... Then whenever Allah wished to inspire something (from Quran), He would inspire”. In another narration: “... it was then revealed piece meal over a period of twenty years”. This gradual revelation took place over a period of twenty-three years, according to the strongest opinion.

Wisdom behind gradual revelation:

1. To strengthen the resolve of the prophet: The disbelievers of the time of the Prophet SAAS ridiculed him for which he was distressed. But Allah reaffirmed in his determination by the continual revelation of Quran. This is what Allah alludes in the Quran:

“And those who disbelieve say, ‘Why was the Qur'an not revealed to him all at once?’ Thus [it is] that We may strengthen thereby your heart. And We have spaced it distinctly.” (Al Furqan-32)

2. To make easy memorization and understanding of Quran: The piecemeal revelation of the Quran made it easier for the companions to understand, memorize and implement the portions that were revealed. If the Quran had been all at once, it might have been difficult for the companions to understand all of its verses properly.

3. To prove the truthfulness of Prophet SAAS: The idolaters and the people of book used to ask the prophet SAAS questions in order to outwit him but every time Allah would reply to their queries. Whenever a situation or crisis arose, the Quran would clearly lay out the situation. Allah says:

“Certainly has Allah heard the speech of the one who argues with you, [O Muhammad], concerning her husband and directs her complaint to Allah. And Allah hears your dialogue; indeed, Allah is Hearing and Seeing.” (Al Mujadalah-1)

Therefore, the fact the Quran came down immediately to cater to the questions and problems of the people proved that it was in fact the word of Allah.

4. To prove the miraculous nature of the Quran: One of the most outstanding miracles of the Quran was that it was revealed over a period of two decades catering a plethora of situations and commanding the Prophet SAAS and the believers to a course of action yet not a single of its six thousand plus verses is contradicted by another. To add to this miraculous nature, the order and arrangement of verses were not done chronologically, rather the prophet would instruct his companions of the location of any new verse. The Quran was literally assembled out of the fragmental revelation.

5. To reveal the laws of Islam in gradual manner: Among the blessings of Allah for human being is that He revealed to them the laws of Islam gradually and thus made it easier for them to adopt these laws.

6. To ease the revelation process on the Prophet SAAS: The process of wahi was a difficult one for the Prophet SAAS. At times he used to sweat profusely, even on a cold night, because of the severity of the inspiration. Had the Quran been revealed all at once, it might have been too difficult for the Prophet SAAS to bear.